METRIC

A-A-59843
November 4, 2009

COMMERCIAL ITEM DESCRIPTION

AXE, ICE

This commercial item description is approved for use by the Defense Supply Center, Philadelphia and is available for use by all Departments and Agencies of the Department of Defense.

1. SCOPE. This commercial item description covers the requirements for ice axes which are used to assist with balance on moderate angled ice slopes and when anchoring to the ice and snow with the pick and spike. It is also used to chop ice and pound anchors into the snow and as a dead man anchor.

2. CLASSIFICATION. The ice axes will be furnished in the following types and sizes:

2.1 Types.

Type I – General mountaineering ice axe
Type II – Technical ice axe with adze
Type III – Technical ice axe with hammer

2.2 Sizing.

Type I – (Size 1-3)
Type II – (Size 1)
Type III – (Size 1)

Comments, suggestions, or questions on this document should be addressed to: Defense Supply Center Philadelphia, Clothing and Textiles Directorate, Attn: DSCP Standardization Team, 700 Robbins Avenue, Philadelphia, PA 19111-5096. Since contact information can change, you may want to verify the currency of this address information using Acquisition Streamlining and Standardization Information System (ASSIST) online database at http://assist.daps.dla.mil/

AMSC N/A FSC 4240

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3. SALIENT CHARACTERISTICS. The ice axe shall comprise of an aluminum shaft with a steel head with a pick, adze or hammer, and spike used to move through moderate and steep ice terrain while meeting the standards in the description.

3.1 Type I. The Type I axe shall be comprised of a pick, head, adze, shaft, and spike. The ice axe design shall provide ease of use with typical combat gloves as specified in Table I.

TABLE I. Physical characteristics (Type I)

Size	Ice Axe Length, centimeters (+/-3)	Weight, grams ±10%
1	60	415
2	68	438
3	75	458

3.1.1 Pick. The pick shall include a serrated design on the underside of the pick.

3.1.2 Head. The axe head shall be a one-piece, ergonomically designed. The axe head shall have 1-2 holes; one for attaching carabiners or webbing when used as a plunging anchor; one for attaching a leash or webbing beneath the top level of the head if desired. The carabiner hole shall be sized to fit all types of carabiners in A-A-59836.

3.1.3 Adze. The adze shall curve slightly downward from the center to each side. The adze shall facilitate chopping of ice and hard snow for constructing steps and anchors.

3.1.4 Shaft. The shaft of the axe shall be straight, with a grip at the bottom for enhancing the grip when chopping steps.

3.1.5 Spike. The spike shall be a “V” –shaped design to enable plunging into the snow.

3.1.6 Protectors. The axe shall be provided with protectors for the spike, adze and pick.

3.2 Type II. The Type II axe shall be comprised of a pick, head, adze, shaft, hand rest, and spike. The picks shall be compatible with Type III picks and comply with the requirements in Table II.

TABLE II. Physical characteristics Type II and Type III

Size	Ice Axe Length ± 3 centimeters	Weight, ± 5grams
1	50	500

3.2.1 Pick. The pick shall include a serrated design on the underside of the entire pick length with a positive clearance and a dropped pick design.

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3.2.2 Head. The axe head shall be of a modular design with an attachment points for replaceable picks. The axe head shall have one carabiner hole for attaching carabiners or webbing when used as a plunging anchor.

3.2.3 Adze. The adze shall curve slightly downward from the center to each side. The adze shall facilitate the aggressive chopping of ice and hard snow for constructing anchors and steps.

3.2.4 Shaft. The shaft of the axe shall be bent back away from the front of the shaft to allow clearance on steep and bulging ice. The shaft shall have a removable hand rest to enable grip when used without a leash.

3.2.5 Spike. The spike shall be beveled for occasional plunging into the snow.

3.2.6 Protectors. The axe shall be provided with a protector for the pick, and adze to protect the sharp ends from damaging other equipment during transport and/or storage.

3.3 Type III. The Type III axe shall be comprised of a pick, head, hammer, shaft, hand rest, and spike and comply with the requirements in Table II. The pick shall be compatible with Type II interchangeable pick.

3.3.1 Pick. The pick shall include a serrated design on the underside of the entire pick length with a positive clearance and a dropped pick design.

3.3.2 Head. The axe head shall be of a modular design with an attachment point for replaceable picks. The axe head shall have one carabiner hole for attaching carabiners or webbing when used as a plunging anchor. The hole shall be sized to fit all types of carabiners in accordance with A-A-59836.

3.3.3 Hammer. The hammer shall be of a one piece design. The hammer shall facilitate pounding in snow anchors and pitons.

3.3.4 Shaft. The shaft of the axe shall be bent back away from the front of the shaft to allow clearance on steep and bulging ice. The shaft shall have a removable hand rest to enable grip when used without a leash.

3.3.5 Spike. The spike may be beveled for occasional plunging into the snow.

3.3.6 Protectors. The axe shall be provided with a protector for the pick and adze, when applicable, to protect the sharp ends from damaging other equipment during transport and/or storage.

3.4 Color. The axes shall be provided in a low reflectance finish and provide low contrast with typical use terrain unless otherwise stated in the contract or solicitation (see 7.2).

3.5 Materials.

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3.5.1 Head. The head shall be made of stainless steel.

3.5.2 Shaft The shaft shall be aluminum.

3.6. Tests. The ice axe shall meet International Mountaineering and Climbing Federation, Union Internationale des Associations d'Alpinisme - (UIAA) Standard 152 for type B (Basic) ice tools.

3.7 Workmanship. The finished ice axe shall conform to the quality of product established by this document. The occurrence of defects shall not exceed the contractors own quality assurance standards and the quality assurance standards defined in the technical data in the solicitation and/or contract.

3.8 Service life. The ice axe shall have no unexpected material or component failures during a continuous one-year cycle. The ice axe shall have no unexpected material or component failures during periodic use over a five year period.

3.9 Labels/barcoding/instruction slip. If applicable, all labeling, barcoding and instruction slip requirements shall be as specified in the solicitation or contract (see 7.2).

4. REGULATORY REQUIREMENTS. The offeror/contractor is encouraged to use recovered materials to the maximum extent practicable, in accordance with paragraph 23.403 of the Federal Acquisition Regulation (FAR).

4.1 Recycled, recovered, or environmentally preferable materials. Recycled, recovered, or environmentally preferable materials should be used to the maximum extent possible, provided that the material meets or exceeds the operational and maintenance requirements and promotes economically advantageous life cycle costs.

5. PRODUCT CONFORMANCE PROVISIONS.

5.1 Product conformance. The products provided shall meet the salient characteristics of this Commercial Item Description, conform to the producer's own drawings, specifications, standards, and quality assurance practices, and be the same product offered for sale in the commercial marketplace. The Government reserves the right to require proof of such conformance.

5.2 Visual examination. Each ice axe shall be examined for the following defects as listed in Table III.

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TABLE III. End item examination

Examine	Defect Description
Finish	Not smooth and adherent
	Not low reflectance, matte finish
	Does not provide low contrast with typical use terrain
Construction	Not free of burrs, rough spots, slivers, flat areas or projections
	Any component loose, missing or not specified type
	Any component fractured, slit, punctured, dented, bowed, malformed or damaged
	Marking etched or indented, contains rough or sharp edges
Labels/barcoding/instruction slip (if applicable)	Incorrect, illegible, omitted or misplaced
Marking	Omitted, missing information or illegible

5.3 Acceptance criteria. Acceptance criteria shall be as specified in the contract or purchase order (see 7.2).

6. PACKAGING.

6.1 Preservation, packing and marking. The preservation, packing and marking shall be as specified in the contract or order (see 7.2).

7. NOTES.

7.1 Sources of documents.

7.1.1 Government documents. Copies of Government documents are available online at http://assist.daps.dla.mil/quicksearch/ or from the Standardization Documents Order Desk, Building 4D, 700 Robbins Avenue, Philadelphia, PA 19111-5094.

DRAWINGS

U.S. ARMY NATICK SOLDIER CENTER

3-3-0142 Axe, Ice, Type I
3-3-0152 Axe, Ice, Type II
3-3-0153 Axe, Ice, Type III

(Copies of drawings are available from the U.S. Army Natick Research Development and Engineering Center, Natick Soldier Center, ATTN: NSRDEC-RDNS-WPW-C Natick, MA 01760)

7.1.2 Federal Acquisition Regulations are available online at http://acquisition.gov/far/index.html or by contacting the Superintendent of Documents at 202-512-1800.

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7.2 Non-Government documents. Non-Government standards and other publications are normally available from the organizations that prepare or distribute the documents. These documents may be available in or through libraries or other informational services.

INTERNATIONAL MOUNTAINEERING AND CLIMBING FEDERATION
UNION INTERNATIONALE DES ASSOCIATIONS D'ALPINISME (UIAA)

UIAA Safety Standard 152 Mountaineering and Climbing Equipment, Ice Tools

(Copies are available online at http://www.theuiaa.org or from the Union Internationale Des Associations D'Alpinisme (UIAA) Monbijoustrasse 61 Postfach CH-3000 Bern 23 Switzerland)

7.3 Ordering data. The contract or order should specify the following:

a. Title, number, and date of this Commercial Item Description.
b. Type, size and color required (see 2.1, 2.2 and 3.4).
c. When required, labeling, barcoding, and instruction slip (see 3.9)
d. Acceptance criteria (see 5.3).
e. Packaging (see 6.1).

MILITARY INTERESTS:

Custodian:
Army - GL
Marine Corps - MC

CIVIL AGENCY COORDINATING ACTIVITY
GSA-FSS

PREPARING ACTIVITY:
DLA-CT

(Project Number: 4240-2009-011)

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